The update decision

Start here: what to change and why

19 October 2026 · Review specification 3.0.0

Keep two model stages, the existing domain/topic system and automatic publication. Tighten source handling and replace confusing stage-based comparisons with clear documentation coverage.

This short decision book lists the proposed changes, implementation order and approval scope. The application has not been changed. The full editable package includes current source archives, proposed templates, JSON files, examples and reference tests.

Read next: Team handbook for the process; Taxonomy and fields for every choice; Prompt sourcebook for the exact current and proposed prompts.

Final update decision

Review specification 3.0.0 • 19 October 2026 • Prepared for a go/no-go decision; application behavior is unchanged.

Recommendation

Keep the existing two-stage architecture and 16-domain/64-topic system. Make the handoff safer, the model inputs smaller and explicit, and the dashboard centered on comparable documentation coverage. Do not add a planning agent, a scoring LLM, a mandatory judge, a graph database or a universal policy-quality index.

The numerical headline should answer **“How many common topics have a documented response?”** Show response coverage and delivery-detail coverage as separate percentages. Keep four bands for topic cells and show reported implementation separately. A shared source profile makes comparisons more interpretable; country priorities remain visible without hidden weights.

Decisions proposed for approval

Decision	Recommended default	Reason
Normal pipeline	Document/domain extraction → code pooling → country/domain organization → code metrics	Smallest change; preserves document and combined views
LLM input	Explicit templates, compiled vocabulary/schema and authorized data only	Prevents old documentation, old prompts and unrelated files entering requests
Scoring headline	Response % plus delivery-detail %; implementation reports secondary	Literal counts with fixed denominators; no arbitrary composite weights
Topic display	Four agreed documentation bands	Clear categories without invented decimal precision
Comparison corpus	Separate NDC-only, NDC+NAP and all-supplied views	Avoids treating different document inventories as equivalent
Priorities	Cited country-priority lens, without changing common scores	Water and tourism can matter differently without corrupting comparability
Publication	Automatic, with partial status when necessary	No human moderation or acceptance queue
Customization	One versioned bundle; basic settings first, advanced fields collapsed	Easy to extend without creating competing sources of truth

What the numbers mean

For ten common topics, six documented responses and two with complete delivery detail produce **60% response coverage** and **20% delivery-detail coverage**. If one topic reports implementation, show **1/10 with implementation reported** separately. Do not blend those three values.

If six response topics are established, two are completely searched without a response and two remain unresolved, show **60-80%**, not a fabricated exact score. The range reflects missing classification information, not statistical confidence. A country total counts unique topics; it is not an average of domain percentages.

A high value means broad documentation within the selected corpus. It does not prove adequate ambition, strong implementation, good outcomes or equal national relevance of every topic. One detailed action can establish the highest topic band, so the detail drawer shows the number and identity of underlying responses.

What must change before activation

Priority	Change	Acceptance evidence
P0	Preserve numeric meaning during quote verification; separate strict eligibility from tolerant highlighting	Minus sign, decimal, range, comparator and unit regression fixtures
P0	Make search coverage and job completion code-owned	No-search, failed source and unreadable page cannot become a complete empty result
P0	Wait for the contributing extraction manifest before topic pooling	A record found through another domain is included; late unrelated uploads do not block forever
P0	Bound output size and split oversized tasks	Truncated output is not retried indefinitely or silently accepted
P0	Preserve quotes, facts, source IDs and variants through organization	Every owned record accounted once; conflicts retained; no unrelated field borrowing
P0	Replace stage maxima and legacy sums in every dashboard consumer	Same metrics, source scope and uncertainty everywhere; document history remains source-local
P1	Expose the versioned configuration editor	Preview prompt/input/schema and change impact; export/restore without file/database drift
P1	Measure model/context choices on representative material	Recall, attribution, false merges, contradictions, cost and latency compared using the same sources

The current quote matcher can erase a minus sign or join a range. The current worker waits only for jobs from the same domain. These are concrete code findings, not hypothetical concerns. Their locations and remaining edge cases are recorded in reference/REVIEW-FINDINGS.md.

Implementation sequence

1. Preserve current source and outputs; add one configuration loader and the lean wire contracts.

2. Fix retrieval/verification/budget accounting; persist sourced atomic records and coverage.

3. Add the frozen input barrier, topic pooling, conservative organization and stable ownership.

4. Add source-profile snapshots, coverage metrics and documented-change comparisons.

5. Update regional, country, topic and document screens; then settings and diagnostics.

6. Run automatic release tests and representative-source evaluations; activate the new method as a versioned release.

The release evaluation is software testing, not a human review step for each country. Users upload/identify sources and configure the tool; once processing starts, it proceeds to published results or clearly labelled partial results automatically. Post-publication users can flag or hide items.

Options deliberately deferred

Option	Why not initially	Reconsider when
Extract every page with a model	More output and duplicate handling; better recall is not established	A fixed benchmark shows material gains over focused retrieval
Universal topic 0-100 quality score	Needs normative topic-specific indicators and weights	Team explicitly wants a separate assessment framework and can define it
Country-specific score weights/N/A inference	Changes denominators and can reward missing evidence	A transparent shared comparison profile is agreed, with verified applicability data
Multi-agent/judge pipeline	Adds cost and coordination without proven value	Error evaluation shows a targeted second interpretation materially helps
All optional taxonomy facets on every request	Extra fields and cognitive load	Stakeholders use those filters enough to justify extraction cost

What is ready, what is not

This review pack includes proposed prompts, editable vocabulary/configuration, strict wire-contract definitions, offline request examples, reference metric calculations, dashboard design, diagrams and team PDFs. Exact current application files and current prompt renders are preserved separately with hashes.

It does not activate new runtime behavior or claim measured LLM accuracy/cost savings. The code migration remains the decision this plan prepares. No API calls, live database migration or country assessment is required to review these files.

Suggested team discussion

Confirm the coverage-first numeric approach; decide whether optional inclusion/group labels should be enabled initially; choose the first comparison source profile; agree the fixed representative evaluation set. These are product-design choices, not recurring manual moderation duties.